

Nominal column
 n categories, no order

Too many categories?
keep the frequent ones,
group the rest
as “uncommon”

Drop one column
 $n - 1$ columns,
avoids the dummy
variable trap

One-hot encoding
 n new columns of 0 and 1

tools for both steps

pandas `get_dummies`
quick data analysis

scikit-learn
`OneHotEncoder`
ML projects: remembers
the categories